

Pediatric Epilepsy Syndromes: Classification and EEG Patterns

Global Pediatric Neurology Network

BACKGROUND: Epilepsy in children encompasses a highly diverse group of disorders. Accurate diagnosis of the specific epilepsy syndrome is critical for predicting prognosis and guiding therapy.

CLASSIFICATION: Key syndromes include Childhood Absence Epilepsy, Benign Epilepsy with Centrotemporal Spikes (BECTS), and severe epileptic encephalopathies such as Dravet syndrome and Lennox-Gastaut syndrome.

DIAGNOSTIC TOOLS: Electroencephalography (EEG) combined with neuroimaging (MRI) forms the cornerstone of diagnosis. Identifying specific interictal epileptiform discharges helps in classifying the seizure type.